consolidate, and lead more effective international groupings will increase. In some cases, small, nimble, and issue-specific coalitions will prove sufficient. This might extend to some areas of emerging technology—such as artificial intelligence and space—where only a few countries or groupings have significant capabilities. But in time, contributing to a parallel institutional architecture can advance Indian interests while contributing to an international order that manages conflict, improves global growth and development, and helps effectively govern the global commons.

Priority 14. Amplify the Global South

Finally, India's objectives of transforming the international order will require it to engage new stakeholders and widen its partnerships. In international politics, like in domestic electoral politics, there is strength in numbers. At a moment when many countries have genuine frustrations that they believe are being overlooked by the world's leading powers, it is India's interests to listen to and channel those frustrations, particularly when India's interests align with that agenda.

The Global South has long been used by historians and in the development community, but less so in international relations. At face value, the countries that constitute the Global South have little in common: no shared language, religion, culture, political system, or even economic profile. But they do have two shared features. One, they have historical experience with colonialism, even if in some cases—as in Latin America—that is two centuries old. Two, the countries of the Global South all developed belatedly after the 1960s if not later. As such, these are states that have been politically marginalized and underrepresented at international institutions.

The renewed Global South agenda was prompted by four recent trends. One, their lack of representation at international organizations was compounded by questions of international lending and debt sustainability. This made them vulnerable to established lenders in the developed world.